

While the Vitruvian Man was inspired by the past, Leonardo drew many inventions that looked forward into the future. They included

an underwater breathing device, a parachute, and a kind of robot—an armor-clad figure operated by gears, wheels, pulleys, and cables.



Leonardo's most memorable ideas were his flying machines. He carefully studied birds and tried to understand how they fly.

FLYING MACHINES

One of Leonardo's larger flying machines was designed to carry a person lying down. The wings, made of pine and silk, would be 33 ft (10 m) across. The machine might have flown had it been somehow first carried into the air. But Leonardo never figured out how to get it off the ground.



This model of a flying machine is based on Leonardo's design.